

US Communications Infrastructure

CoreWeave, Inc.

Rating

Underperform

Price Target

 **CRWV**

67.00 USD



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CoreWeave (CRWV) 2Q26 Preview: A holding pattern

While CoreWeave is not expected to report until early August, we reflect on the 1Q26 results and our learnings intra-quarter. We believe that 2Q may be more of a bridge quarter, as we wait for power ramps, maturing deployed capacity, and the resulting step-up in revenue, to show through.

2Q earnings may be relatively uneventful. Management has continued to frame power beginning to come online around the back half of 2Q, and the company reiterated its target to reach ~1.7GW of operational power by year-end, suggesting that the more visible underlying earnings power is likely to emerge as capacity ramps further through 2H. CRWV has been clear that they've sold out of their 2026 capacity and much of their 2027, so we don't anticipate revenue gains. As a reminder, the company is guiding to \$30M-90M AOI in 2Q, which implies \$790M-\$1.05B in 2H2026 - expectations for 2Q are relatively measured.

Demand and backlog momentum are unlikely to be the issue. The company tends to announce large contracts as they happen, so backlog is likely to be within range of expectations. We believe the sticking points will continue to be timing of deployments, capex intensity, margins, and interest burden, and that the stock will continue to be a wait-and-see story until more infrastructure is fully energized and begins monetizing. As [we have written post 1Q earnings](#), we believe that there is little room for operational error as a project-level margin below 21% and/or an average fitout period of over 8 weeks would likely cause an FY26 AOI miss, but we don't anticipate an answer on that this quarter.

We'll be watching for updates on power delivery, sequential margin expansion, and backlog visibility into 2027. As the company mentioned that 1Q's margin pressure was predominantly "timing-based, not economic," since a powered shell begins incurring lease, power, and depreciation costs before contribution margins typically normalize by the 3rd month, we'll be watching for an on-track ramp to 1.7GW by year-end as well as an upward trajectory in AOI that would validate the communicated sequential margin step-ups. We expect 2026 revenue to remain within the previously-guided range and that the run-rate revenue will remain on track for a \$18-19B FY26 exit rate.

Investment Implications

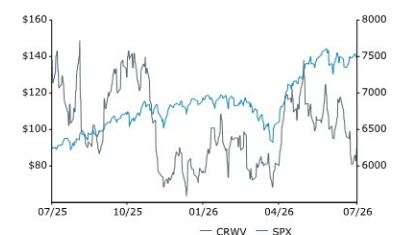
We are Underperform on CRWV with a price target of \$67.

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
CRWV (USD)	(1.20)	(4.20)	(2.41)	Revenues (M)	5,131	12,371	19,731	96.1%	EV/EBITDA (x)	33.6	13.2	7.0
				EBITDA (M)	2,442	6,232	11,736	119.2%	EV/EBIT (x)	N/M	432	34.6
									Adjusted P/E (x)	(75.2)	(21.4)	(37.3)

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Close Date	8 Jul 2026
CRWV Close Price (USD)	90.00
Price Target (USD)	67.00
Upside/(Downside)	(26)%
52-Week Range	160.42/63.80
SPX	7,482.71
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	NA
Market Cap (USD) (M)	49,281
EV (USD) (M)	82,162
Performance	YTD 1M 6M 12M
Absolute (%)	25.7 (12.1) 16.7 (40.6)
SPX (%)	9.3 1.0 8.1 20.2
Relative (%)	16.4 (13.1) 8.6 (60.8)
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.	

Price Performance, 1YR



DETAILS

PRE-QUIET PERIOD IR COMMENTARY

We checked in with IR just before they entered their quiet period and confirmed that the distribution of power coming online was still back half weighted for 2026, that the leasing environment remains hot, and that the biggest growth challenge is financing, not demand. The company noted that the team is becoming increasingly more strategic about the allocation of capacity among customers given the demand environment. On the power side, most of the capacity currently being contracted is for late 2027 through 2028. Availability remains constrained in the next 6–12 months, but conditions appear significantly more favorable in the 18-month+ horizon. Additionally, the company expects larger, longer-dated contracts to be the foundation of the business going forward as it scales, which is no surprise considering the magnitude of recent deals with Meta and Jane Street.

PRIOR QUARTERLY PERFORMANCE

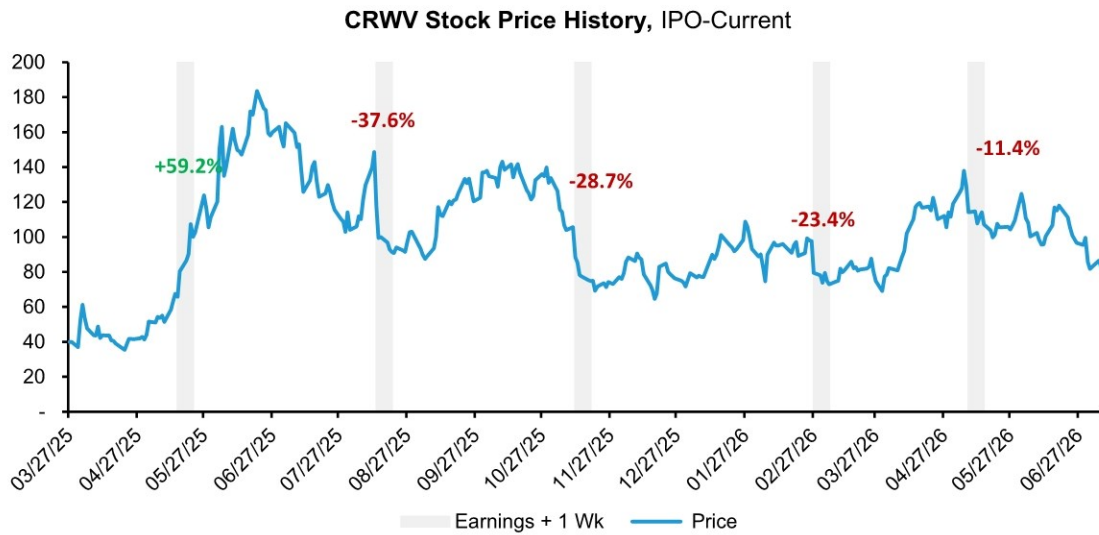
CRVV is notoriously volatile and momentum-driven: it is not uncommon to see the stock move by 20–30% on a related news item, especially on large multi-year hyperscaler customer contracts. That said, the stock's movement following recent earnings releases suggest a tendency towards post-earnings softness, falling 11–21% after each of the last three quarters in the post-print trading session. We also note that the effect may be more sustained, as stock price reactions over the last 3 FQs ranged from -11% to -38% one week post-earnings, and from -14% to -22% one month post-earnings. Generally, the CoreWeave story is an enthusiastic, forward-looking one—large future wins are already baked into expectations, with meaningful upside materializing during inter-quarter updates i.e. contract signings. Then, when it's time to report, earnings tend to throw water on the fire. Even with solid operations, it's difficult to execute perfectly while in hyper-growth mode.

EXHIBIT 1: **CRVV Historical Performance, 1Q25-1Q26**

	Metric	Q1 2025	Q2 2025	Q3 2025 (revised)	Q4 2025 / FY25	Q1 2026
	Revenue vs expectations	Beat	Beat	Beat	Slight Beat	Slight Beat
	Backlog & demand signal	25.9B; strong early backlog	30.1B; doubled YTD	55.6B; +25B QoQ	66.8B; +11.2B	99.9B; +33.1B
Growth	Active power (MW)	~420MW; on track – Mixed	~470MW; on track – Mixed	~590MW; +120MW QoQ – Mixed	>850MW; +260MW in Q4	>1000MW; +150MW
	Contracted power (GW)	1.6GW – Mixed	2.2GW – Mixed	2.9GW; +>600MW QoQ – Mixed	>3.1GW; +~2GW in 2025 – Mixed	>3.5GW; +~0.4GW
	Customer Concentration	No customer >50% backlog; still concentrated – Mixed	Hyperscaler expansions; some diversification – Mixed	Largest customer ~35% of backlog; >60% IG backlog – Met/beat	1M+ spend cohort +150%; more enterprise logos – Met/beat	Largest customer ~45% of revenue in 1Q, Meta contract expansion – Mixed
	Adjusted op income & margin	163M, 17%, in line	200M, 16%, in line	217M, 16%, beat	88M, 6%, miss	21M, 16%, miss
Profitability	EPS / net income vs Street	-\$0.60	-\$0.27	-\$0.08	-\$0.56	-\$1.12
	Interest expense dynamic	264M; higher than expected	267M; elevated with scaling	311M; spreads improving	388M; WACC down	536M; WACC slightly up
	Cost of capital trend	IPO expected to lower WACC over time – Mixed	DDTL 3.0 at SOFR+400 (900bps better) – Met/beat	DDTL 2.0 amendment, 25bps tighter notes – Met/beat	Eff. interest -300bps YoY, -600bps vs 2023 (~700M savings) – Met/beat	Effective interest rate -270bps YoY – Met
	CapEx vs plan	1.9B; aligned with success-based model – Mixed	2.9B; accelerated build – Mixed	1.9B; lower than anticipated on delays	8.2B Q4; 14.9B FY; ahead of reduced guide	7.7B Q1; 21% miss, FY26 Lower Guidance slightly up
Guidance	Revenue guidance vs Street	FY25 4.9–5.1B; above early models	FY25 raised to 5.15–5.35B; above consensus	FY25 cut to 5.05–5.15B; below prior expectations – Missed	2026 rev 12–13B; decent but overshadowed by other issues	Reaffirmed 2026 rev 12–13B; overshadowed by margin misses
	Profitability guidance	FY25 AOI 800–830M; lower margin path – Mixed	AOI unchanged at 800–830M despite higher rev – Mixed	FY25 AOI cut to 690–720M – Missed	2026 AOI 900M–1.1B with trough in Q1; viewed as light – Missed sentiment	2026 AOI 900M–1.1B with Q1 expected to be their lowest

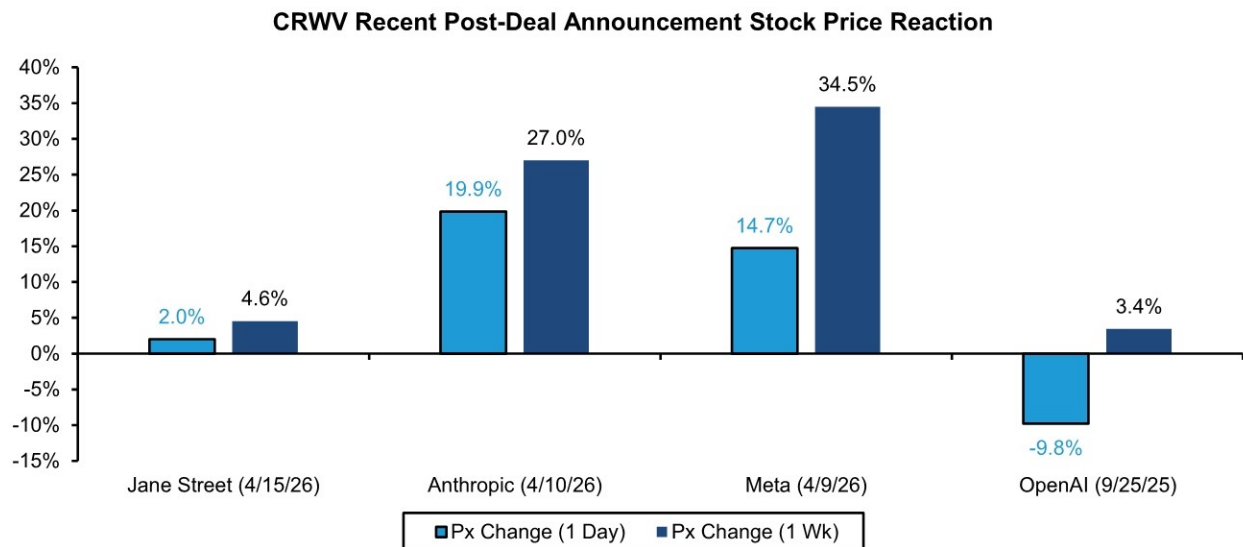
Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 2: **CRVV Stock Price History w/ 1-Week Post-Earnings Reaction**



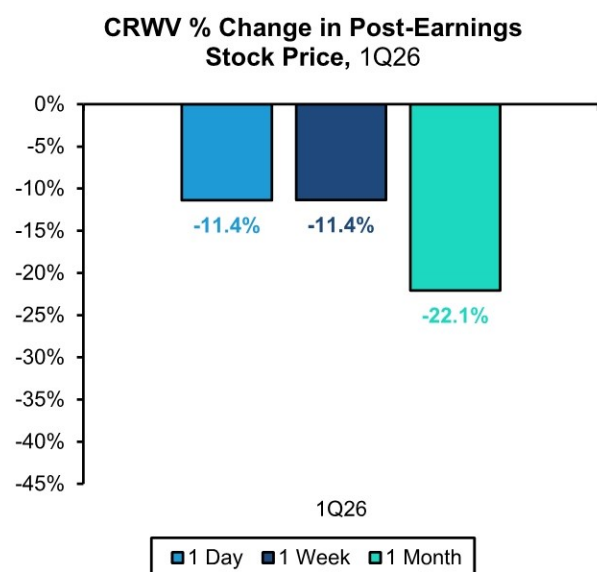
Stock price change calculated as of 1 week / 5 trading days post-earnings release; shaded area represents earnings release + 1 week / 5 trading days
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 3: **CRVV Recent Post-Deal Announcement Stock Price Reaction (1-Day and 1-Week)**



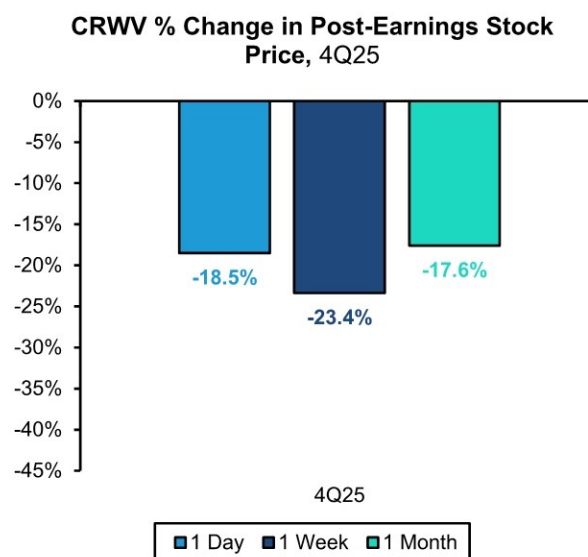
Source: Bloomberg, Company disclosures, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 4: CRWV 1Q26 Post-Earnings Stock Reaction



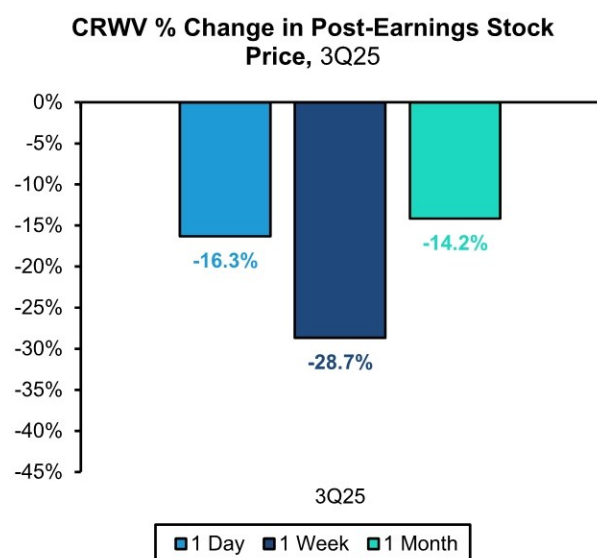
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 5: CRWV 4Q25 Post-Earnings Stock Reaction



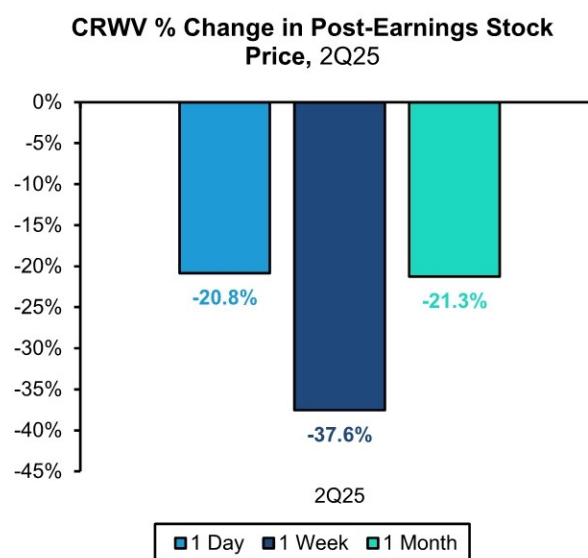
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 6: CRWV 3Q25 Post-Earnings Stock Reaction



Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 7: CRWV 2Q25 Post-Earnings Stock Reaction



Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

WHAT WE'RE WATCHING

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Source: Company disclosures, Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

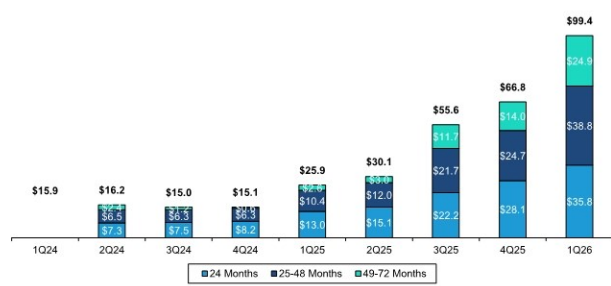
REVENUE + BACKLOG METRICS

EXHIBIT 9: **CRWV Quarterly Historical Revenue (\$M)**



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

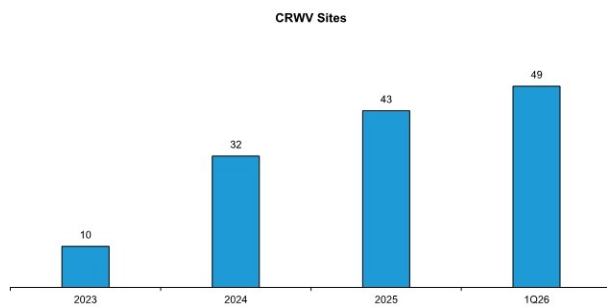
EXHIBIT 10: **CRWV Historical Backlog (\$B)**



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

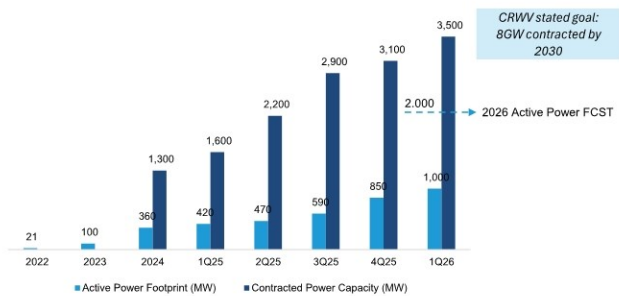
CONTRACTED V. ACTIVE POWER METRICS

EXHIBIT 11: **CRWV Total Sites (Units)**



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

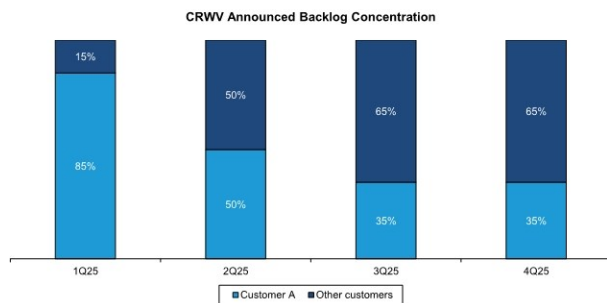
EXHIBIT 12: **Total Active & Contracted Power Capacity (MW)**



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

CUSTOMER CONCENTRATION METRICS

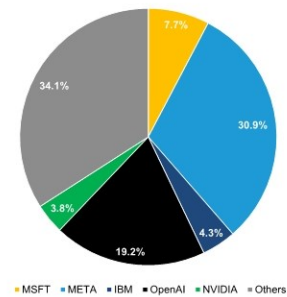
EXHIBIT 13: **CRWV Announced Backlog Concentration**



Based on 3Q25 disclosures; we assume concentration remains in similar range as of FY25 year-end.

Source: Company filings and announcements, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

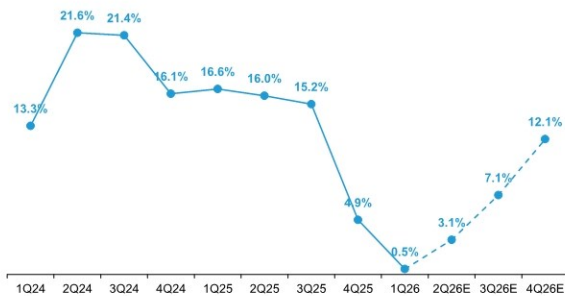
EXHIBIT 14: **CRWV Estimated Backlog Concentration (%)**



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

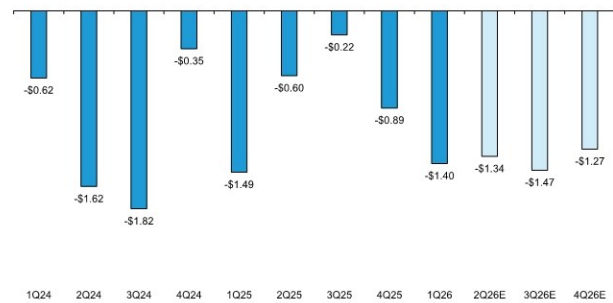
MARGIN METRICS

EXHIBIT 15: CRWV Adj. EBIT Margin (%)



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

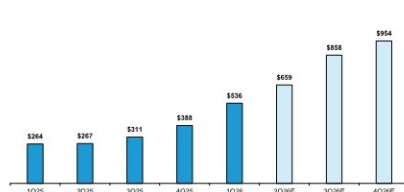
EXHIBIT 16: CRWV Diluted EPS (\$)



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

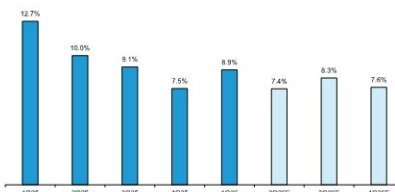
INTEREST EXPENSE AND COST OF CAPITAL METRICS

EXHIBIT 17: CRWV Quarterly Interest Expense (\$M)



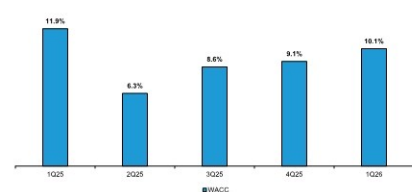
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 18: Annualized Quarterly Interest Rate (%)



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

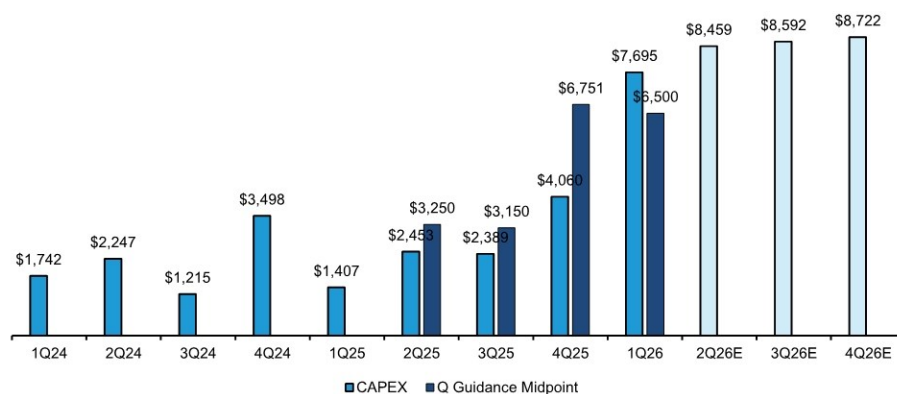
EXHIBIT 19: Annualized Quarterly Cost of Capital (%)



Source: Company filings, Bloomberg, Bernstein Analysis

CAPEX METRICS

EXHIBIT 20: CRWV Quarterly Capex Expense (\$M)



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

DEBT METRICS

EXHIBIT 21: CRWV Debt Overview

Debt Description	Outstanding ¹ (\$M)	Eff. Interest Rate (%)	Issue Date	Maturity Date
DDTL 1.0	\$1,438	15%	Jul-23	Mar-28
Revolving Credit Facility	\$1,500	6%	May-25	Nov-29
2030 Senior Notes	\$2,000	10%	May-25	Jun-30
DDTL 2.0	\$4,425	11%	May-24	Aug-30
DDTL 3.0	\$1,700	9%	Jul-25	Aug-30
DDTL 2.1	\$3,000	9%	Sep-25	Dec-30
2031 Senior Notes	\$2,750	9.8%	Apr-26	Oct-31
DDTL 5.0	\$3,100	~8.1% ²	May-26	Nov-31
2031 Convertible Senior Notes	\$2,588	2%	Dec-25	Dec-31
DDTL 4.0	\$1,260	7%	Mar-26	Mar-32
2032 Senior Notes	\$1,250	9.6%	Jun-26	Jul-32
2032 Senior Notes	\$2,285 ³	8.5%	Jun-26	Jul-32

1. As of March 2026 10Q and June 2026 press releases; partial repayments intra-quarter are not captured

2. SOFR + 450bps

3. €2 billion

Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

PRIOR GUIDANCE REVISIONS

EXHIBIT 22: CRWV Guidance 2Q26 & FY26

Top line	Event	CRWV Comments
Full Year 2026		
Revenue	1Q26 Earnings Call	The strength of our Q1 results, [...] gives us confidence in reaffirming our full year guidance of \$12 billion to \$13 billion of revenue. We now expect to end 2026 with \$18 billion to \$19 billion of annualized run-rate revenue , increasing the low end of our expectations by \$1 billion. (Prev. Range \$17B-\$19B)
Adj Operating Income	1Q26 Earnings Call	Also reaffirmed their guidance of \$900 million to \$1.1 billion of adjusted operating income
Operating Margins	1Q26 Earnings Call	While Q1 represented the trough of our margin trajectory, we remain on track for sequential margin expansion through the balance of the year with revenue and margin growth expected to inflect as we cross from Q2 to Q3. Our Q1 adjusted operating margin was 1%, which we continue to expect to be its low-point as cloud capacity further ramps in coming quarters.
CAPEX	1Q26 Earnings Call	We now expect CapEx of \$31 billion to \$35 billion. The increase on the low-end from our previous guidance is related to increases in component pricing. (Previous range \$30B-\$35B)
2Q26		
Revenue	1Q Earnings Call	For Q2, we expect revenue in the range of \$2.45 billion to \$2.6 billion.
Adj. Operating Income		We expect Q2 adjusted operating income of \$30 million to \$90 million as margins start to expand from their Q1 lows.
Interest Expense		Our Q2 interest expense is expected to be in the range of \$650 million to \$730 million.
CAPEX		We expect CapEx to be \$7 billion to \$9 billion as we continue to bring significant capacity online in-service of our contracted revenue backlog.

Source: Company filings and disclosures, Bernstein Analysis

BERNSTEIN LONG VIEW

Our case hinges on our longer-term revenue expectations for CRWV, which are significantly lower than street expectations. In general, we question CRWV's ability to continue to sign large-scale hyperscale deals as data center supply becomes more readily available (2028+) and are concerned that hyperscalers are likely to attempt head-on competition with neoclouds for enterprise business.

We disagree with CRWV's premise that its existing software moat will hold up to hyperscaler attacks, especially given hyperscalers' scale and ability to spend. We do not believe the structural concerns abate with increased AI demand, though the timing for our call may be pushed further out.

Importantly, we do not believe the tide will shift for CRWV in the very near term and anticipate them signing an incremental \$45B of deals between now and the end of 2027. We are roughly in line with consensus for 2026 expectations. By 2027, we begin to diverge, and by 2028, we are ~15% below consensus revenue estimates, accelerating through the forecast window.

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 23: CRWV Income Statement Overview

All values in millions, except per share data

	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26E	3Q26E	4Q26E	1Q27E		FY 2025	FY 2026	FY 2027	FY 2028	FY 2029
Total operating revenues	1,213	1,365	1,572	2,078	2,518	3,863	3,913	4,523		5,131	12,371	19,731	28,004	32,006
Cost of revenue	313	369	509	716	841	1,233	1,171	1,308		1,453	3,961	5,515	7,251	7,857
Technology & Infrastructure	670	747	950	1,273	1,508	2,256	2,207	2,505		2,929	7,243	10,740	14,667	16,333
Sales & Marketing	37	45	52	69	43	66	67	77		144	244	335	476	544
General & Administrative	174	152	150	164	174	228	191	176		651	757	768	1,090	1,246
Total operating expenses	1,194	1,313	1,661	2,222	2,566	3,782	3,635	4,066		5,177	12,204	17,358	23,484	25,979
Operating income	19	52	(89)	(144)	(48)	81	277	456		(45)	166	2,373	4,521	6,027
Total other (expense) income	(262)	(289)	(378)	(512)	(659)	(858)	(954)	(1,097)		(1,170)	(2,984)	(4,668)	(5,429)	(6,218)
Income (loss) from continuing operations before taxes	(243)	(237)	(467)	(656)	(707)	(778)	(677)	(640)		(1,215)	(2,818)	(2,295)	(909)	(190)
Income tax expense (benefit)	48	(127)	(15)	84	-	-	-	-		(48)	84	-	-	-
Net income (loss)	(291)	(110)	(452)	(740)	(707)	(778)	(677)	(640)		(1,167)	(2,902)	(2,295)	(909)	(190)
Dividends and accretions on Series C redeemable prefs	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-		(29)	-	-	-	-
Net income (loss) attributable to common stockholders, basic	(291)	(110)	(452)	(740)	(707)	(778)	(677)	(640)		(1,196)	(2,902)	(2,295)	(909)	(190)
Change in fair value of common stock warrants	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-		(27)	-	-	-	-
Net income available to common stockholders	(291)	(110)	(452)	(740)	(707)	(778)	(677)	(640)		(1,223)	(2,902)	(2,295)	(909)	(190)
(+) Adjustments	160	69	168	151	126	193	196	226		562	666	987	1,120	1,280
Adjusted Net Income	(131)	(41)	(284)	(589)	(581)	(584)	(481)	(414)		(606)	(2,236)	(1,308)	212	1,090
Earnings per share (EPS)														
EPS (basic)	(0.60)	(0.22)	(0.89)	(1.40)	(1.34)	(1.48)	(1.28)	(1.21)		(2.42)	(5.51)	(4.35)	(1.72)	(0.36)
EPS (diluted)	(0.60)	(0.22)	(0.89)	(1.40)	(1.34)	(1.47)	(1.27)	(1.20)		(2.42)	(5.45)	(4.23)	(1.64)	(0.34)
Adjusted EPS (diluted)	(0.27)	(0.08)	(0.56)	(1.12)	(1.10)	(1.10)	(0.90)	(0.77)		(1.20)	(4.20)	(2.41)	0.38	1.93

Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	8 Jul 2026	Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				EV/EBITDA (x)		
			Closing Price			Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
CRWV (CoreWeave)	U	USD	90.00	67.00	(60.8)%	USD	(1.20)	(4.20)	(2.41)	33.6	13.2	7.0
SPX			7,482.71									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**CoreWeave, Inc.**

We value CRWV on a forward EV/Adjusted EBIT multiple. Our \$67 price target is based on an Enterprise Value calculated as 28.4x our 2027E Adj. EBIT per share of \$5.81.

RISKS**CoreWeave, Inc.**

The main upside risks to our price target/Underperform rating on CRWV are 1) Delays in hyperscaler built capacity coming online may maintain CRWV value proposition, 2) Development of CRWV's specialized software platform which maintains demand for CRWV operated data centers, and 3) Continued shortage in power supply to power data centers may sustain CRWV's pricing power

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION**EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS****Bernstein brand**

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

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- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 15 pp
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- Neutral (N): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to perform in line with preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
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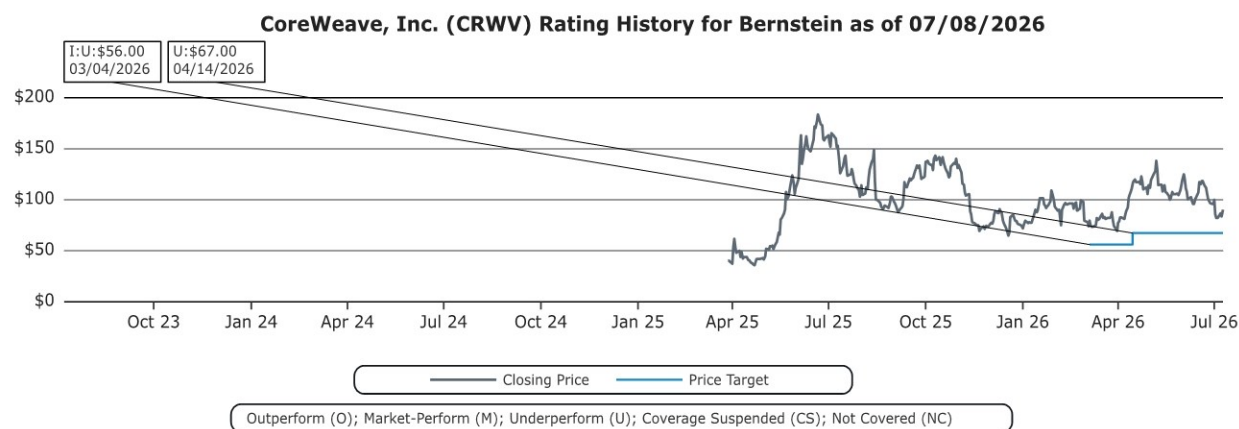
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Underperform	SELL	13.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months. As of June 30, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

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